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N.A.A.C.P. Executive Director Returns To Oakland

BENJAMIN HOOKS-"HOW SOON WE FORGET WHERE WE CAME FROM"

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(Oakland, Calif.) - In his second visit to this Port city in four months, Benjamin Hooks, the dynamic, newly appointed executive director of the NAACP, delivered an eloquent, timely speech here last week in which he:

- Criticized the Black community for "forgetting where we came from"; and
- Warned that the civil rights gains made during the 1960's are in danger of being lost because America has moved into "one of the most conservative ages we have lived in in the last 30 years."

The charismatic NAACP leader, in town to address a joint National Achievement Week Awards luncheon co-sponsored by the Oakland branch of the NAACP and Omega Psi Phi Fraternity, held at Goodman Hall in Jack London Square last Saturday, was interrupted numerous times with applause and murmurs of "I heard that" as he reminded the predominantly Black crowd of the importance of remembering their roots.

Recalling the integration of Central High School in Little Rock, the Montgomery bus boycott launched by Rosa Parks, the Birmingham bombing in which four Black girls were



NAACP Executive Director BENJAMIN HOOKS receives standing ovation following his speech at the National Achievement Week Awards luncheon co-sponsored by the Oakland NAACP and Omega Psi Phi Fraternity held at Jack London Square.

killed, and other milestones in the civil rights struggle, Hooks, the first Black person ever elected to the Federal Communications Commission, noted:

"We've come up a way that has been watered with tears, but we have forgotten so soon. I think that we as Black folk have an

"Showcase" For Oakland?

NATIONAL GUARD JOBS PLAN UNVEILED

(Oakland, Calif.) - Governor Edmund G. Brown, Jr., unveiled details of his plan for a new "community" National Guard to be staffed by Black and other unemployed minority young adults of this city at a special press conference held last week.

Meanwhile, a state-backed plan whereby low-interest loans will be provided to rehabilitate rundown housing in Oakland has received a two million dollar boost.

Flanked by Mayor Lionel Wilson and Major General Frank Schober, commander of the California National Guard, at the November 17 City Hall press conference, Governor Brown said that the "Oakland Guard" will provide jobs and training for 500 young men and women in 50 job skills.

"The National Guard has helped in disasters and floods, but now it will help in the more subtle problems of an urban community," the governor said. "We are going to train young people who otherwise couldn't find their way



Governor JERRY BROWN, with Gen. FRANK SHOBER, announces controversial plan to create "community" National Guard in Oakland.

into the job market."

Also attending the press conference were prominent Black attorney Donald P. McCullum, the president of the New Oakland Committee, and Dale Reed, an 18-year-old Black youth who is the first recruit in the Oakland Guard.

The program, part of the governor's overall plan to make Oakland a showcase for state aid, will be financed by \$315,000 of federal Comprehensive Employment Training Act (CETA) funds. Applicants between 17 and 35 years old will be screened by the state Employment Development Department (EDD), which administers the funds.

The plan will work as follows:

- Those chosen will get 30 days pre-basic preparation from the California Guard.
- Then they will go to the U.S. Army for basic training, followed by instruction in marketable skills like electronics, truck driving and cooking.

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